

1813

“THE BULLET THAT WILL KILL ME IS NOT YET CAST.”

Napoleon Bonaparte, statement at Montreueux, February 17, 1814

NAPOLÉON BONAPARTE, AFTER HIS HUMILIATING RETREAT IN Russia (see 1812), began to experience the rapid decline of his military might. This was driven home by the decisive defeat at the **Battle of Leipzig** (also known as the Battle of the Nations) fought October 16–19. France had nearly 185,000 troops, but the allies outnumbered them with more than 300,000 soldiers from Austria, Russia, Prussia, and Sweden. Even after this loss, Napoleon still refused to sign a peace deal that would put France's boundary back to the Rhine River and the Alps.

While Russia was caught up in the Napoleonic conflict, it was also entangled with territorial deals further east; Russia and Persia signed the **Treaty of Gulistan**, in which Russia was given a large area of Persian Caucasus territory. The deal brought to an end the **Russo-Persian War** (1804–13), which had been triggered by Russia's annexation of Georgia and the **Karabakh** (a region in present-day Azerbaijan). The territories, which had been a dominion of Persia, had appealed to Persia's shah for help in resisting Russia.

In **Venezuela**, Simón Bolívar (see 1811) had won an important victory against the Spanish and captured **Caracas**, though Spain's forces would later defeat him, forcing him into exile for two years. During this period he went to Jamaica and Haiti to regroup and enlist further support before returning to Venezuela in 1816.

1814



An engraving of a palanquin (litter) being carried in Mauritius.

ALLIED TROOPS PURSUED

Napoleon to Paris, where he was captured. He abdicated on April 6 and was exiled to the island of Elba, off the Tuscan coast of Italy. To replace him, **Louis XVIII** (1755–1824)—brother of the beheaded Louis XVI—was placed on the French throne. Afterward, the European powers convened the **Congress of Vienna** (September 1814 to June 1815). Part of the resulting settlement gave Prussia two-fifths of Saxony; set up a German Confederation; and allowed Britain to retain France's Indian Ocean islands of **Mauritius** and the **Seychelles**, which it had captured.

1815



A painting depicts the 17th-century Temple of Tooth, located in the kingdom of Kandy, where one of Buddha's teeth is preserved.

ALTHOUGH HE WAS EXILED FROM FRANCE, Napoleon rallied enough supporters to help him mount his return, and he entered Paris on March 20—just 11 months after his forced departure. Louis XVIII fled, and what became known as the “**Hundred Days**” began. Once he had an army assembled, Napoleon mounted attacks against his enemies, defeating Prussia at **Ligny** (in present-day Belgium) on June 16. He fared much worse two days later at the **Battle of Waterloo**, against British troops led by the Duke of Wellington, who had brought the Peninsular War (see 1808) to an end the previous

year. Napoleon had been on the verge of victory, but the arrival of Prussian reinforcements secured his defeat. Napoleon was forced to abdicate once again, but this time he was to be exiled much further away—the island of **St. Helena**, a British outpost in the South Atlantic, where he died in 1821.

At the same time, Britain's troops in **Ceylon** (Sri Lanka) had taken control of the kingdom of **Kandy**, which meant the entire island was under British rule.

Battle of Waterloo

This clash was the definitive defeat of Napoleon Bonaparte, after which he was forced to abdicate and go into exile.

1816



A native inhabitant in Alaska, territory which Russia had claimed.

A RUSSIAN ORTHODOX PRIEST, Father Sokoloff, was sent to **Sitka**, in the Alaska territory, to build a church in the town as part of Russia's bid to colonize the region. Alaska had lingered as an outpost but settlements began to grow as trade in sea otter furs flourished.

In southern Africa, **Shaka** (c. 1787–1828), a fierce warrior, took over the rule of the **Zulus**. He reorganized the army, leading his tribe to military victory, and incorporated conquered tribes into the Zulu nation.



Charter Act ends East India Company monopoly and allows missionaries to enter India

October 19 Napoleon defeated by Allies at Leipzig (Battle of the Nations)

Egyptian forces recapture Jeddah and Mecca from Wahhabis

Simón Bolívar leads invasion of Venezuela and is proclaimed “El Libertador” (The Liberator)

January 14 Treaty of Kiel; Denmark gives Sweden Norway in exchange for Pomerania

April 6 Napoleon abdicates; exiled to island of Elba, returning less than a year later

May 30 Treaty of Paris signed

April 11 Louis XVIII (1755–1824) regains French throne (to 1824)

War in Nepal between East India Company troops and Gurkhas over annexation of villages (to 1816)

December 11 Ferdinand VII (1784–1833) is returned to Spanish throne; scraps liberal reforms

British annex Ceylonese kingdom of Kandy

April 23 Second Serbian Uprising (to 1817) gives Serbs more autonomy

Napoleon exiled to island of St. Helena, where he later dies in 1821

June 18 Battle of Waterloo ends in Napoleon's surrender

September Congress of Vienna starts

United Provinces of the Río de la Plata set up as independent states in South America

July 9 Argentina gains independence from Spain

Shaka (c. 1787–1828) becomes Zulu king

August 27 Bombardment of Algiers by Anglo-Dutch allies seeking release of Christian slaves

Java returns to Dutch rule after a period of British control